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EDITORIAL: HUEY MUST BE SET FREE!

Huey Newton, Minister of Defense of the Black Panther Party for Self Defense, lies in the hospital at San Quentin State Prison, with a gunshot wound in his stomach, inflicted by an Oakland cop. An Oakland cop is dead and buried and a second cop lies somewhere in some hospital with three bullet wounds in his body. Huey has been charged with the murder of the first cop and the shooting of the second.

The shooting occurred in the heart of Oakland's black ghetto. Huey is a black man, a resident of Oakland's black ghetto, and the two cops were white and lived in the white suburbs. On the night that the shooting occurred, there were 400 years of oppression of black people by white people focused and manifested in the incident. We are at that crossroads in history where black people are determined to bring down the final curtain on the drama of their struggle to free themselves from the boot of the white man that is on their collective neck. Huey Newton knew that the chief instrument of oppression of black people in America is the police departments of the cities. Through murder, brutality, and the terror of their image, the police of America have kept black people intimidated, locked in a mortal fear, and paralyzed in their bid for freedom. He knew that the power of the police over black people has to be broken if we are to be liberated from our bondage. These gestapo dogs are not holy, they are not angels, and there is no more mystery surrounding them. They are brutal beasts who have been gunning down black people and getting away with it. They call this "justifiable homicide" carried out by an officer of the law in the line of duty. Black people understand that this is very true -- but not in the way that the lying mass media would have people believe.

The "duty" that these wretched jackals are carrying out is to keep the niggers in check; the peace that they are charged with keeping is the peace of the power structure, the peace of the Bank of America and General Motors. To perform their duty, they must necessarily disturb the peace of black people. In fact, black people have had no peace since the first day they set foot on this bloody Babylonian soil called America. Peace is what black people seek, what they are determined to have. Peace is what is being withheld from black people.

Huey Newton is a child of Malcolm X. Malcolm said that we will get our freedom by any means necessary, and 20,000,000 black people heard his voice and concurred in his message. Huey



Newton heard Malcolm's voice and understood his message. 20,000,000 black people heard Malcolm's message and that same 20,000,000 feel exactly the same way about it as Huey Newton feels.

20,000,000 black people say that the cops are down wrong from the get-go and that Huey Newton is right. 20,000,000 black people say that Huey is not guilty of any crime, that he is now being held as a political prisoner, and they want him set free. We know that white people, the majority of them, neither understand this nor do they believe that black people really mean this. Some white people understand this, know it to be true and just, and they back black people up in their just demands for liberation and an end to the terror.

Huey Newton's case is the showdown case. It marks the end of history. We cannot go a step beyond this point. Here we must draw the line. We say that we have had enough of black men and women being shot down like dogs in the street. We say that we have had enough of cops being set free with a verdict of justifiable homicide. We say that black people in America have the right to self defense. Huey Newton has laid his life on the line so that 20,000,000 black people can find out just where they are at and so that we can find out just where white America is at.

We have reached the point in history where we must claim that a black man, confronted by a bloodthirsty cop who is out to take his life out of hatred for the black race, has a right to defend himself -- even if this means picking up a gun and blowing that cop away. Make no mistake about it; that is where we are at today. A cop is nothing but a man in a uniform. Through their propaganda and brainwashing of the people they have us believing that there is something supernatural or special about a cop. A cop is a human being just like anybody else, he came into the world just like anybody else, and he can leave this world just like anybody else.

Every week, from every corner of America, we hear the reports of how some cop has shot and killed some black man, woman or child. We are sick and tired of hearing such news and we don't want to hear any more. The only way that is not be from now on is that there will be no more reports of black people being massacred or we want to hear more reports about more dead cops shot down by black men. There can be no two ways about it, there can no longer be a double standard, one for black people and one for white people, one for cops with

"The Spirit of The People is Greater Than The Man's Technology"

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